



A Day in Mumbai

Mumbai's most interesting sights are quite widespread, but with some stamina and the help of an occasional taxi you can cover a remarkable amount of ground in a day.

MORNING The magnificent harborside **Gateway of India**, built for the visit of King George V in 1911, is the best place to start, though you'll need to keep the hawkers at bay. Then head inland to spend a couple of hours in the **Prince of Wales Museum** (now officially known as Chhatrapati Shivaji), which houses some of India's finest paintings and sculpture.

AFTERNOON Take a taxi up to **Malabar Hill** and stroll along its leafy ridge, passing by the eerie Parsi **Towers of Silence** and visiting the serene **Jain temple**, whose stunning interior is encrusted with mirrors. Farther down there is also the famous Hindu **Walukeshwar temple**.

EVENING As dusk falls, wind your way down the hill to the top end of **Chowpatty Beach** for some great people-watching while munching a plate of tasty *chaat* by the Arabian Sea.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Mumbai lies on India's west coast and is a domestic hub for **rail** and **bus** networks. Chhatrapati Shivaji international **airport** lies 19 miles (30 km) north of Mumbai.

WHERE TO STAY

Sea Shore (inexpensive) is a good budget option in Colaba, with some sea-facing rooms, but only shared bathrooms. +91 22 2287 4237
City Palace (moderate) is a reliable and conveniently located hotel opposite VT station. www.hotelcitypalace.net

Taj Mahal Palace & Tower (expensive), colonial Bombay's oldest hotel, has views of the Arabian Sea and the Gateway of India; it now has a plush modern annex. www.tajhotels.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.maharashtratourism.gov.in

Left The puffed rice, noodles, and potatoes of *bhel puri* are tumbled with onions, cilantro, chili pepper, and tamarind sauce

Below A huge statue of Ganesh is transported through the water off Chowpatty Beach during the Ganesh Chaturthi Festival

